

to be five times more powerful than the current A9-based chipsets, and is still more power efficient. The new iPad was only not given an A15-based processor due to the manufacturing not being mature enough. The A5X chipset has juiced A9 to its limits, and we expect the next iteration to feature a much more efficient and powerful Cortex A15 processor.

As of now, ARM dominates Android market, and Intel dominates the Windows PC market, but not only is Intel moving over to the Android realm, ARM is also getting an ARM-based version of Windows later this year. Therefore, we'd have Windows and Android tablets running on both ARM and Intel processors. The competition will only be good for the end users, and we can expect the processing capabilities to increase even faster in the future.

Haptic Feedback

One point often overlooked is how little the current generation of 'touch-devices' actually do for the sense of touch. While all components of mobile devices have advanced by leaps and bounds, notice how mobiles still use the same old dumb omnidirectional vibration motor since the lancient brick sized phones.

Intel Measured Smartphone Power Consumption (Identical Display Brightness)				
	Standby (3G)	Talk (3G)	Browsing (3G)	Video Playback 720p
Apple iPhone 4S	~38mW	~800mW	~1.3W	~500mW
Intel Medfield Reference	~18mW	~700mW	~1.0W	~850mW
Samsung Galaxy S II	~19mW	~675mW	~1.2W	~650mW

One of the companies aiming to change this scenario is Immersion Corporation. With their software already having been shipped in 400 million electronics devices, chances are that a mobile device you currently own already has software by Immersion Corp. in it. But even with the most sophisticated software, the current hardware in phones limits the haptic feedback. Current phones ship with vibrational motors that require time to start and stop. Immersion's HD Haptics platform, released earlier this year, provides 'High Definition' haptic feedback if the manufacturers replace the motors with piezoelectric actuators. Piezoelectric actuators